



Enraged by the eagle's greed, Loki grabbed a branch from the fire and swung it at the bird's head. The eagle took hold of the branch in his talons and flew into the air – with a terrified Loki still dangling from the other end. Up into the freezing sky soared the eagle, until all of the Nine Worlds were visible and the stars seemed close enough to touch.

"Take me down, I beg you," Loki said through chattering teeth.

"You know, you're not the only being who can shapeshift, Loki. In truth, I am Thjazi the Giant."

"I don't care who you are, just put me down!"

"I will, but only if you bring me the goddess Idun, and her golden fruit."

Now, it was only by eating Idun's fruit that the Aesir stayed young, strong and immortal. Without it the gods would age, wither and die. But, as usual, Loki placed his own life above all others and agreed to the giant's terms.